

DTC Ecommerce Company

Shopify Performance Review

February 2023 - February 2026
Analysis by Ryan Shahidi

The logo consists of the letters 'DTC' in a bold, white, sans-serif font, centered within a dark purple square. This square is positioned on the right side of the slide, which has a dark blue background.

Agenda

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What Was Analyzed

Three years of Shopify data across orders, customers, sessions, and products

1,621
Orders

1,505
Customers

103K
Sessions

\$134k
Total Revenue

Period

February 2023 to February 2026 [36 months of order, session, and customer data]

Method

Cleaned and transformed raw data using SQL, then modeled in Power BI, including cohort analysis, funnel decomposition, and YoY trend comparison

The Headline Finding

The business's revenue is on the rise but it is **failing to retain customers.**

+78%

Revenue growth YoY

12%

Of customers ever order twice

1.4%

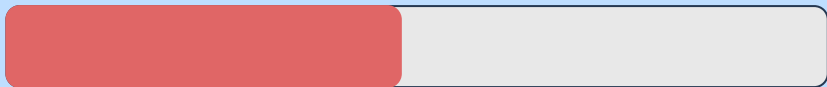
Of sessions convert

Returning customers are 2x more valuable, but only 12% come back

The customers who repeat are far more valuable, there just aren't many of them

One-time Customers

\$94 LTV



Returning Customers

\$201 LTV

2.1x more revenue per returning customer

Customer Mix

88% one-time (1,324)

12%

181 customers placed a second order

So What?

Repeat customers are very valuable, but there aren't enough of them. An 8% increase in return rate would result in a projected \$12,883 increase in revenue at current customer volume.

96% of sessions never reach the cart

The biggest leak in the conversion process is getting people to engage in the first place

Total Sessions 103k



↓ 96% drop off (the leak)

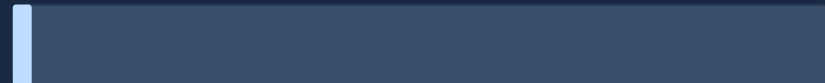
Added to Cart 4k



Reached Checkout 3k



Completed Checkout 1k (1.4%)



So What?

Once customers add items to the cart, the funnel works efficiently.

There is a leak upstream where traffic arrives, but doesn't engage. This points to a landing page or traffic quality issue, not a checkout problem.

When customers come back, they come back in 8–90 days

A narrow, predictable window means retention can be an addressable target



~78% of repeat orders happen between 8-90 days after the first order

So What?

The retention problem is concentrated, which is good. There's a clear 80-day window where the business has the customer's attention. That makes this a targetable problem, and one well-timed email flow can address it.

Part Two

So what should we do about it?

Five recommendations, ordered from immediate to strategic.

Run a win-back campaign to the 1,229 single-purchase customers

The “easy money” play

What To Do

- Send a single email to the 1,229 customers who have ordered exactly once
- Lead with the best selling product (Product A) and a returning-customer offer
- Time the send before launching the ongoing email sequence in rec #2

Why This First

This is lowest-effort and fastest recommendation to carry out. All it takes is a single email send (create a customer segment within the Shopify Admin.)

Success Looks Like

3%+

Reactivation rate

~37

Returning customers

~\$3000

Immediate revenue

Build a 8–90 day post-purchase email sequence

Capture the second order in the window where customers are most likely to return

What To Do

- Day 8** Educational/usage tips. Aim to build product trust and reinforce value.
- Day 30** Replenishment + soft offer. Mid-window nudge with light incentive.
- Day 85** Last-chance discount. Catch the customer before the window closes.

Why This Window

Over 75% of all repeat orders happen within 8-90 days of the first. This sequence puts a touch in front of the customer at the start, middle, and tail of that window.

Success Looks Like

5%+

Repeat rate (12% -> 17%)

\$8,052

Estimated revenue increase*

*At current customer volumes

Audit the top 5 landing pages for pre-cart drop-off

A 1-week diagnostic to identify where the 96% leak comes from

Hypotheses to Test

- A Traffic quality. Wrong audience reaching the site (broad ads, off-target keywords).
- B Page experience. Slow load, weak product copy, unclear value prop.
- C Pricing friction. Price shock at the product page.

Scope

Look at where your visitors are coming from (Google ads, Instagram direct, email, organic search) and which pages they're landing on (homepage, a specific product page, a blog post.) Find out which combinations are bringing people who never buy, and figure out whether the problem is the audience, the page, or the price.

Success Looks Like

A clear answer to whether the leak is a traffic problem or a page problem, and a clear direction on which fix to invest in first.

Treat the first-purchase product as a retention lever

If certain products lead to higher repeat rates, steer first-time buyers toward them

The Logic

Cohort retention is flat across acquisition months, meaning the discriminator isn't who we acquire. The next variable to test is what they buy first.

What To Do

- Segment customers by first product purchased
- Compare 90-day repeat rate within each segment
- If a winner emerges, feature it as the entry product on the homepage and in paid ads

Success Looks Like

Knowing which product should we put in front of new customers.

If repeat rates differ meaningfully by entry product, this becomes a great lever for retention.

Adopt repeat rate as the north-star KPI for the next two quarters

Without a tracked goal, none of the above will get prioritized

The Goal

12% → 18-20%

Now Target (6 months)

What To Do

- Decide method to track metric
- Review monthly alongside revenue
- Tie initiatives 1-4 to lift this metric

Why it Matters

Revenue is a lagging indicator. Repeat rate is the leading one for this business.

If repeat rate increases, revenue will naturally follow and compound.

Where to go from here

A three step plan to move repeat rate from 12% to 18-20%

Growth depends on getting new customers and keeping them. We can put ourselves in a great position by increasing the retention rate and the solving the funnel problem.

Step 1

Quick wins

- Send the win-back email (rec 1)
- Add repeat rate to monthly review (rec 5)
- Kick off pre-cart audit (rec 3)

Step 2

Build the system

- Launch 8-90 day email flow (rec 2)
- Act on audit findings (rec 3)
- Run first-product retention analysis (rec 4)

Step 3

Measure and adjust

- Measure win-back results
- Compare repeat rate vs baseline
- Steer entry product based on rec 4 findings

Methodology & limitations

Method

- Star-schema data model: fact_orders + dim tables (date, location, product, customer)
- Cohort retention analyzed by acquisition month
- Conversion funnel built from session-level Shopify analytics data
- YoY comparisons use full calendar years (2024 vs 2025)

Limitations

- Inventory data should be validated before drawing operational conclusions
- Secondary channels (Shop, Facebook, Instagram) likely under-attributed
- No unit cost or profit data was available for analysis
- Revenue projections in findings & recommendations are estimates